

rooms with a lot of reverberation or echo. FM auditory enhancement systems are now widely used in schools because of their versatility and portability for use in or out of the school building.

Infrared systems. Infrared systems transmit clean, clear sound invisibly to hearing impaired listeners. These provide better hearing in public places without the hassle of wires and cords, and suffer less from interference emanating from pagers and other outside radio signals. But, they may have limited accessibility because of issues related to line-of-sight or distance between the emitter and the transceiver. Nevertheless, as costs come down, the popularity of infrared systems is increasing.

Captioned television and live speech captioning. Captioning refers to the addition of text to a visual display, where the words that are spoken are seen as text. The early form of captioning was seen primarily as subtitles for translating foreign films.

Live speech captioning is another variation of this technology that allows individuals with hearing impairments to access words as they are being spoken. This technology works much like steno keyboards that are used to record judicial proceedings. When captioning is used in educational settings, a stenographer typically enters information as the teacher talks and the text is displayed on a computer monitor. This technology has proven to be very helpful for students with hearing disabilities who are enrolled in college courses or who attend public lectures.

Telecom devices for the deaf

Telecommunication devices for the deaf (TDD) are widely known. These enable persons with no hearing to make or receive telephone calls. The device is attached to a telephone and resembles a small keyboard with a screen to display the incoming or outgoing messages. Some TDDs have a



An advanced remote control that offers one-touch binaural program and volume control

paper printout to record a permanent copy of the conversation.

To use a TDD, the user types a message on the keyboard that is automatically converted into tones and transmitted over the phone line to another TDD, which converts the message back into text form. In this system, both the sender and the receiver of the message must have access to the technology.

Although these technologies are not typically used in the classroom environment, they enable students with disabilities to interact with each other outside of the school environment for both academic and social reasons, just as their non-disabled peers do.

Cochlear implants. A cochlear implant is a relatively new device designed to provide sound information for people with profound hearing impairments. While hearing aids and other assistive devices amplify sound, an implant can actually enable the wearer to hear sounds that were previously indistinguishable. The implant, which is surgically placed beneath the skin, bypasses the damaged parts of the inner ear and stimulates nerves that have not been stimulated before. Signals are sent continuously when sound is present in the environment,

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